Experiment No. 09

Funding, Legal and IPR Awareness – Case Study

A.1 Aim

- To study the **funding, legal requirements, and Intellectual Property Rights (IPR)** of a selected business or start-up.
- To analyze how funding, legal compliance, and IPR protection contribute to the successful operation and growth of a business.

PART B

(PART B: TO BE COMPLETED BY STUDENTS)

Roll No.: C60

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Class/Batch: SE-C2

Selected Business/Start-up: Navro Living's

Business Idea: Balcony, terrace, and rooftop gardening services

Date of Experiment: _____

Date of Submission: _____

Grade: _____

B.1 Observations and Learning

1. Name and Type of Selected Business

NAVRO Living is a gardening and landscaping service that transforms balconies, terraces, and rooftops into attractive green spaces. It provides garden design, plant selection, installation, and maintenance services.

2. Products/Services Offered

- Balcony garden design and installation.
- Terrace and rooftop gardening.
- Vertical gardening for small spaces.

- Kitchen garden setup.
- Plant-care and maintenance services.

3. Target Customers

The target customers are apartment owners, homeowners, working professionals, families, cafés, offices, and housing societies interested in creating green spaces.

4. Initial Funding Requirement

The estimated initial funding required is ₹2,50,000.

Expense Head	**Estimated Cost (₹)**
Gardening tools and equipment	45,000
Website and branding	25,000
Initial plants, pots, soil, and materials	50,000
Transportation setup	20,000
Registration and legal expenses	10,000
Marketing and promotion	20,000
Working capital	80,000
Total	2,50,000

5. Sources of Funding

Funding Source	**Amount (₹)**	**Purpose**
Personal savings	1,50,000	Initial investment
Family support	50,000	Purchase of materials and equipment
Bank loan or other eligible finance	50,000	Working capital and business expenses
Total	2,50,000	

These are proposed funding sources; any external finance depends on eligibility and approval.

6. Business Structure

NAVRO Living can initially operate as a sole proprietorship, which is suitable for a small business managed by one owner. It allows relatively simple management and direct decision-making.

7. Major Legal Requirements

- Business structure and registration: Choose a suitable structure and complete applicable registrations.
- Business permissions: Obtain local trade permissions where required.
- Tax requirements: Maintain accounts and obtain GST registration if applicable.
- Consumer protection: Clearly communicate service prices, terms, and customer responsibilities.
- Workplace safety: Use safe installation practices, especially for rooftop and balcony structures.
- Contracts and payments: Maintain written quotations, invoices, and customer agreements.

8. Applicable Intellectual Property Rights (IPR)

Business Asset	**Possible IPR**	**Reason**
NAVRO Living brand name	Trademark	Helps distinguish the business from competitors.
NAVRO Living logo	Trademark and potentially copyright	Helps protect brand identity and original artwork.
Website text and photographs	Copyright	Protects original creative content.
Promotional videos and graphics	Copyright	Protects original creative work.
Unique product or planter design	Design registration, where eligible	May protect a qualifying visual design.
Original gardening methods	Trade secret, where applicable	Confidential business know-how may be protected.

A patent would generally be relevant only if the business developed a qualifying new invention or process. Ordinary gardening services do not automatically qualify for patent protection.

9. Major Business Challenges

Area	**Challenge**	**Possible Solution**
Funding	Limited money during the initial stage	Start with small projects and control expenses.

Legal	Understanding applicable registrations and permissions	Verify requirements with the relevant authorities.
IPR	Copying of the brand name, logo, or content	Consider trademark protection and retain evidence of original work.
Competition	Existing nurseries and gardening services	Offer customized designs and quality service.
Business Growth	Difficulty attracting initial customers	Use Instagram marketing, referrals, and partnerships.

10. Recommendations for Business Growth

- Funding: Start with personal savings and gradually reinvest profits.
- Legal: Maintain proper financial records, invoices, agreements, and applicable registrations.
- IPR: Check the availability of the NAVRO Living name and consider trademark registration for the brand.
- Future growth: Introduce maintenance subscriptions, premium garden packages, nursery partnerships, and online bookings.

B.2 Conclusion

A case study of NAVRO Living was prepared by analysing its funding requirements, legal considerations, and Intellectual Property Rights. The estimated initial investment is ₹2,50,000, which may be arranged through personal savings, family support, and external finance. The study identified the importance of suitable business registration, applicable legal compliance, and protection of the brand name, logo, and original content. It helped me understand how proper financial planning, legal awareness, and IPR protection can support the successful operation and future growth of a business.

B.3 Question of Curiosity

1. What is the total funding required for your selected business?

   The estimated initial funding required for NAVRO Living is ₹2,50,000 to purchase equipment, materials, develop the website, promote the business, and maintain working capital.

2. Which funding source is most suitable for your business and why?

   Personal savings are the most suitable initial source because they avoid loan interest and allow the owner to retain control. Family support or an eligible loan can cover additional requirements.

3. What are the major legal requirements applicable to your business?

   The major requirements include applicable business registration, local permissions where required, tax compliance, proper accounting, customer agreements, and safe installation practices.

4. Which business asset should be protected through IPR?

   The NAVRO Living brand name, logo, original website content, photographs, and promotional videos should be considered for appropriate intellectual property protection.

5. Which type of IPR is most important for your selected business?

   Trademark protection is particularly important because it can help protect the NAVRO Living brand name and logo, subject to registration requirements and availability.

6. What could happen if your business does not follow the required legal procedures?

   The business may face penalties, legal disputes, restrictions on operations, or difficulties obtaining required registrations and permissions.

7. What would you do if a competitor copied your brand name, logo, or product?

   I would preserve evidence of the copying, check my intellectual property rights, and seek appropriate legal advice. If necessary, I would use the relevant complaint or legal process.

8. What funding, legal, or IPR-related changes would you suggest to help your business grow?

   I would maintain proper financial records, explore suitable funding options, complete applicable registrations, consider trademark protection, and use written agreements with customers and suppliers.

Result

A case study of NAVRO Living was successfully prepared. The funding requirement, possible funding sources, legal considerations, applicable intellectual property rights, major business challenges, and recommendations for future growth were identified and analysed. This study demonstrates the importance of funding, legal compliance, and IPR awareness in developing and protecting a business.